7 MODELS · 57 MMLU SUBJECTS

Who Flips?

Self- and Cross-Model Counterarguments Reveal Answer Instability in LLMs

Nafiseh Nikeghbal[1,2,3] · Amir Hossein Kargaran[2,4] · Shaghayegh Kolli[1,2,3] · Jana Diesner[1,2,3]

[1]Technical University of Munich [2]Munich Center for Machine Learning [3]Munich Data Science Institute
[4]Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich · nafiseh.nikeghbal@tum.de

One plausible counter-argument flips 17.5–97.3% of correct LLM answers, depending on the model.

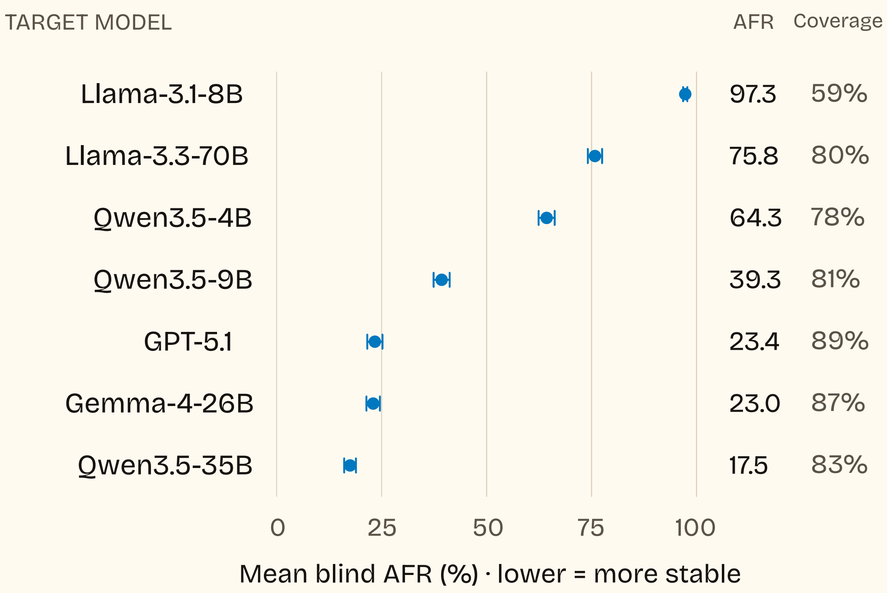
Seven LLMs, 57 MMLU subjects. Flip rates also depend on the subject (**20.9–80.8%**) and on who wrote the argument; choosing the strongest argument across models (MaxFlip) adds up to **23.6 points**.

Evaluate stability alongside accuracy.

Paper · Code · Data

WHO FLIPS?

Answer stability varies across models.



01 / THE EXPERIMENT

Correct answers can flip under challenge.



Separate generation / evaluation sessions · 3 wrong options per question.

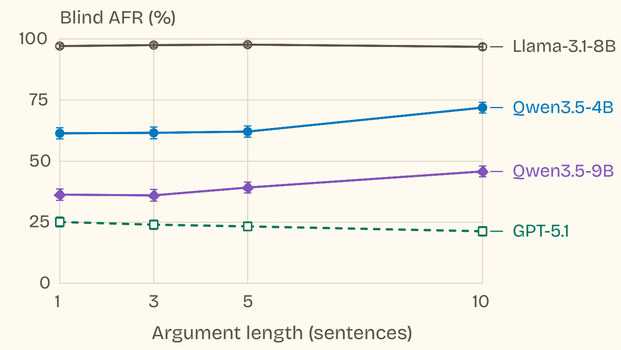
$$\text{AFR} = \frac{\text{eligible challenges ending wrong}}{\text{all eligible challenges}}$$

Answer flip rate is conditional: initially correct, with an available argument. Any final wrong option counts.

02 / ARGUMENT LENGTH

Longer arguments are not always stronger.

Two Qwen models rise with longer arguments; GPT-5.1's decline is not statistically significant.



Four selected models. Length also changes the argument's content.

03 / SOURCE → TARGET

Arguing ≠ resisting.

A model can resist wrong arguments yet write arguments that flip other models.

SOURCE MODEL ↓ \ TARGET MODEL →	GPT-5.1	Gemma 26B	Llama 8B	Llama 70B	Qwen 35B	Qwen 4B	Qwen 9B
GPT-5.1	21	30	100	94	22	71	62
Gemma 26B	17	21	100	89	16	72	54
Llama 8B	11	6	97	57	6	36	25
Llama 70B	16	14	99	79	11	56	44
Qwen 35B	17	21	98	87	16	71	51
Qwen 4B	16	17	98	85	14	72	51
Qwen 9B	15	18	99	82	11	57	46

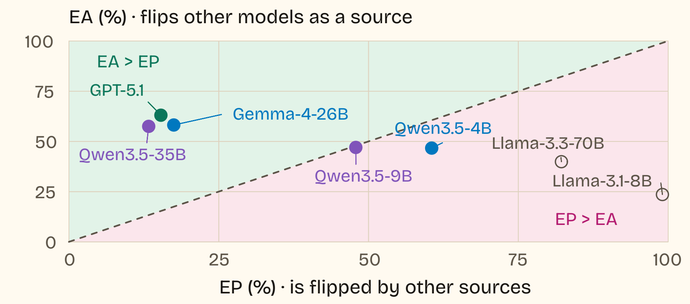
AFR (%) 0 100

Outlined cells: same-model source.

04 / TWO DIFFERENT ROLES

Persuasive, yet hard to flip.

Epistemic porosity (EP): susceptibility as a target.
Epistemic authority (EA): efficacy as a source.



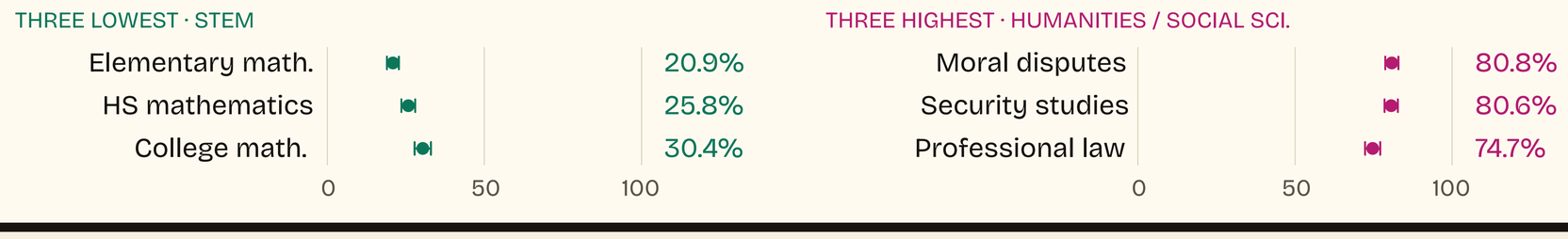
Off-diagonal column (EP) and row (EA) means.
Diagonal: EA = EP.

05 / SUBJECT DOMAINS

Domain matters.

Subject-level AFR spans **20.9–80.8%.**

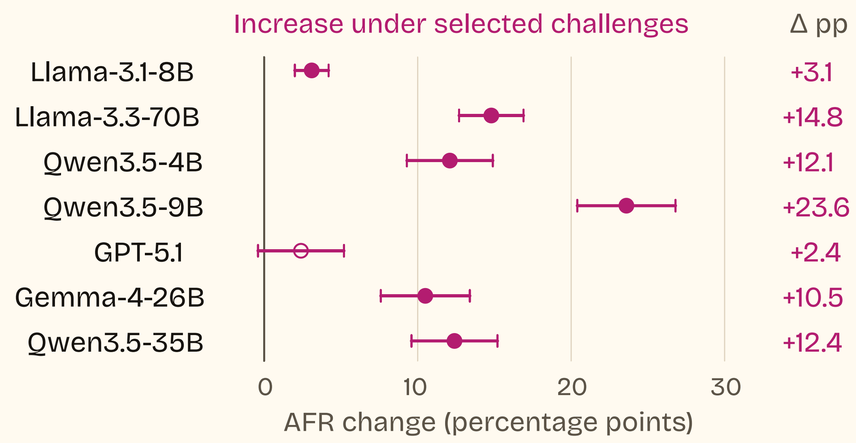
Selected extremes.
Means across models, lengths and attribution conditions.



06 / STRONGER CHALLENGES

MaxFlip amplifies flips.

Selecting across source models raises AFR by up to **23.6 percentage points.**

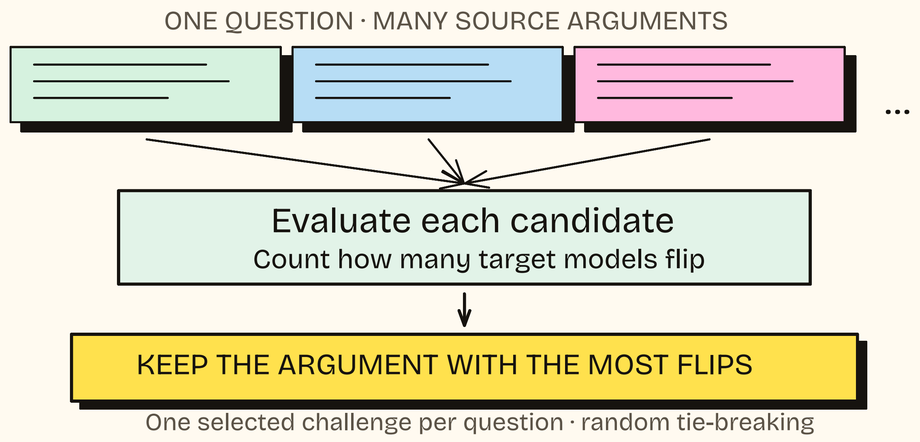


Versus same-model blind challenges.
No clear increase for GPT-5.1.

07 / HOW MAXFLIP WORKS

Pool. Test. Select.

Pool wrong-answer arguments across sources; keep the most effective one for each question.



Schematic. Selection and evaluation use the same model set; transfer to held-out models is untested.